

Eradicating Poverty in Ijesha Land

A study edition of the 2025 proposal to the Owa Obokun Adimula of Ijesha Land: a lifetime project to eradicate poverty in homes and families using LoveCards, with explanations.

Revival and progress, one family at a time.

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About This Study Edition

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

26th May, 2025

To: His Imperial Majesty Owa Clement Adesuyi Haastrup Ajimoko III, Owa Obokun Adimula and the Paramount Ruler of Ijesha Land

His Imperial Majesty,

Warm greetings to you in the name of love, unity, and progress.

The document behind this booklet is a letter. It was written on the 26th of May, 2025, one day after the coronation of the Owa Obokun Adimula of Ijesha Land, and it was addressed to him directly. It congratulates the new king, then asks him for something: the honour of beginning a lifetime project to eradicate poverty in the homes and families of Ijesha Land by means of LoveCards.

Read quickly, it is four pages of respectful correspondence. Read carefully, it is a whole argument about why nations stay poor and what would have to change for that to end — an argument that begins not with money, policy or trade but with love in the home. This study edition sets out to open that argument up, paragraph by paragraph, so that it can be weighed, understood and applied by readers who are not kings and who live nowhere near Ijesha.

What this edition is and is not

Everything printed in a box marked “From the original leaflet” is the wording of the letter as it was written, with spelling and punctuation lightly corrected. Everything else — the explanations, the background, the applications and the questions — is study notes prepared by Practical Love Publications. These notes are not the author’s own words and should never be quoted as though they were.

The notes stay within what the letter actually claims. Where the letter names something briefly — the heritage of Ijesha Land, the work of LoveCards, the transformations it says were witnessed — the notes explain what the claim means and why it matters, without adding stories, figures or histories that the letter does not itself supply.

A note on the missing page

One page of the original letter is not available. Its absence falls near the close, and the surviving text resumes in the middle of a sentence. This edition marks that gap plainly where it occurs rather than smoothing it over or inventing a bridge. What is missing is missing.

A note on the outcome

This is a proposal, not a report. It asks for permission, support and a hearing. Whether that hearing was granted, and what has followed from it, the letter itself cannot tell us, and these notes will not speculate. The value of the document for a reader today does not depend on the answer, because the case it makes stands or falls on its own merits and can be acted on by any household that finds it persuasive.

A letter to a king that turns out to be a letter to every home.

How to use this study

- **Personal reading.** Read one section at a time with your Bible open, look up the references, and write down one thing you will do as a result.
- **Family reading.** Read the boxed letter text aloud, then the section, and let each member of the household answer one of the closing questions.
- **Community or fellowship group.** Use the sections as the basis for discussion about your own town: what is poor here, why, and what a household can actually change.
- **Leaders, chiefs and pastors.** The letter is a model of how to approach authority with a proposal. Sections on honour, alignment and the specific ask repay close attention by anyone who must make a case to those in power.

Scripture quotations in these notes are from the King James Version (KJV). You are urged to read each passage in its own context and to satisfy yourself that the application offered here is faithful to it.

The Letter, Its Date and Its Occasion

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

To: His Imperial Majesty Owa Clement Adesuyi Haastrup Ajimoko III, Owa Obokun Adimula and the Paramount Ruler of Ijesha Land

Letters are shaped by their moment. This one was written on the 26th of May, 2025, and the letter itself explains why that date matters: the coronation had been “recently concluded on the 25th of May, 2025”. The ink was barely dry on a new reign.

Why write on the second day

A proposal delivered in the first days of a new administration is a different thing from the same proposal delivered in its fifth year. At the beginning, direction is still being set, priorities are still being chosen, and a ruler is listening for what his reign is going to be about. Later, the calendar is full and the pattern is fixed.

There is nothing manipulative in this. It is simply the recognition that timing is part of wisdom, and Scripture treats it as such.

A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver.

Proverbs 25:11 (KJV)

Fitly spoken means, among other things, spoken at the fitting time. The same words that land well in one season are ignored in another. Anyone with a good proposal and no hearing should ask not only whether their case is sound but whether they have brought it at a moment when it can be received.

Who is being addressed

The letter is addressed to the Owa Obokun Adimula, named as the Paramount Ruler of Ijesha Land. In the Yoruba arrangement of authority, a paramount ruler is not merely a ceremonial figure; a traditional throne carries real weight in the life of the towns under it, in matters of custom, land, community order and the tone of public life. What such a throne blesses tends to spread; what it ignores tends to remain small.

This explains the strategy of the letter. The writer is not asking the king for money. He is asking for the throne's blessing on a work that will be carried out house by house. A project that a paramount ruler has welcomed can travel through a whole people in a way that the same project, unblessed, cannot.

The form of the greeting

“Warm greetings to you in the name of love, unity, and progress.” Three words, and they will govern everything that follows. Love is the method the letter will propose. Unity is the effect it will promise. Progress is the outcome it will hold out. A careful reader notices that the writer has stated his entire case in the salutation before making any argument at all.

For reflection

1. Is there a proposal or a request you have been carrying that has never found the right moment? What would the right moment look like?
2. Who holds influence over the tone of life in your own community, and has anyone ever put a good case before them?
3. If you had to state your life's purpose in three words, as this letter does in its greeting, what would they be?

Greetings to a New King: Honour and Authority

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

It is with great joy that I extend my heartfelt congratulations to you on the auspicious occasion of your coronation, recently concluded on the 25th of May, 2025, a momentous event marking the dawn of a new era of leadership, peace, and prosperity in every home and family in Ijesha land.

Before the request comes the congratulation, and it is not merely a courtesy to be got through. The whole letter is built on the assumption that honour given to authority is right in itself, and that a Christian minister approaching a traditional throne should come with genuine respect rather than with suspicion.

Honour is commanded, not merely advised

Render therefore to all their dues: tribute to whom tribute is due; custom to whom custom; fear to whom fear; honour to whom honour.

Romans 13:7 (KJV)

Paul is writing to believers living under an empire that was often hostile to them, and still he instructs them to render honour where honour is due. The New Testament pattern is consistent. Peter, writing under similar pressure, gives the same instruction in even plainer terms:

Honour all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honour the king.

1 Peter 2:17 (KJV)

Four commands in one verse, and the honour of the king sits in the same breath as the fear of God — distinct from it, subordinate to it, but not opposed to it. This is the posture the letter takes throughout: reverent towards the throne, but plainly the servant of a higher one.

Prayer for those in authority

Scripture goes further than honour and requires prayer, and it explains the reason:

I exhort therefore, that, first of all, supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men; for kings, and for all that are in authority; that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty.

1 Timothy 2:1-2 (KJV)

The stated purpose is a quiet and peaceable life for ordinary people. Good authority is not a small matter; it is the condition under which families can raise children, work, worship and prosper without fear. A people who criticise their rulers constantly and pray for them never have inverted the apostle's order.

The line the letter does not cross

It is worth marking what the letter does not do. It does not flatter the king with divine titles. It does not suggest the throne is the source of blessing. It congratulates, it honours, and then it speaks of the Lord as the one who restores and the Bible as the standard to which families must return. Honour is given fully, and worship is withheld entirely. That is the biblical balance, and it is easy to lose in either direction.

Honour the throne. Worship only God. The letter does both, and confuses neither.

For reflection

1. When did you last pray by name for those in authority over your town, state and nation?
2. Do you find it easier to criticise leadership or to honour it? What does Scripture ask of you in that area?
3. Is there anyone in authority over you whom you have honoured with words but not with prayer?

The Request Itself: A Lifetime Project

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

As a ministry deeply committed to the message of LOVE, we humbly submit this proposal to request the honour of beginning a lifetime poverty eradication project targeting the homes and families of Ijeshas in Ijsha Land.

Here is the actual request, and every word of it repays attention. It is worth reading the sentence again slowly, because four decisions are packed into it that most poverty proposals do not make.

First: it is a lifetime project

Not a programme, a campaign, a launch or a season. A lifetime. The writer is committing the remainder of his own life and asking the throne to bless something that will outlast announcements and photographs.

This matters because poverty of the kind the letter describes is not a short-term problem and does not yield to short-term work. Habits of the heart are formed over generations and unformed over generations. Any honest proposal to change how a people love must be measured in decades.

And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.

Galatians 6:9 (KJV)

Second: it targets homes and families

Not the economy, not the schools, not the government, not the market. Homes and families. This is the letter's central and most distinctive claim, and everything else in it follows from this choice.

Most poverty interventions treat the household as the place where results show up. This letter treats it as the place where causes live. If families are where values are formed, where children learn what is worth pursuing, where money is either shared or hoarded, and where the next generation of traders, officials and parents is shaped, then a change that does not reach the home has not reached anything durable.

Third: it uses a specific, humble tool

LoveCards. Not a policy, not a fund, not an institution — a card carrying a message. The smallness of the instrument is not an accident, and a later section takes it up in detail.

Fourth: it asks permission

“We humbly submit this proposal to request the honour of beginning.” The writer does not announce that the work will be done; he asks whether he may begin. A ministry convinced it has the answer to a people’s poverty could easily have written in a different tone. This one submits its case to the authority of the land and waits.

The stated mission

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

Our mission is to reignite the flame of LOVE in the hearts of Ijesha people; to burn out the weeds of greed and materialism that have taken root and to restore the foundation of godly love that once defined this land.

Three verbs carry the mission: **reignite, burn out, restore**. Each assumes a past in which things were better. You cannot reignite what was never lit, and you cannot restore what was never there. The letter is not proposing to introduce love to Ijesha Land. It is proposing to recover something the writer believes the land once had and has lost.

That framing is gracious, and it is also strategically wise. A man who tells a people they have never been good will be resisted. A man who tells them they have been better than this, and can be again, is appealing to their own memory as his witness.

For reflection

1. What is the longest commitment you have ever made to anything? What made you able to keep it?
2. In your own community, what was better a generation ago that could be recovered rather than invented?
3. When you see a problem clearly, is your instinct to announce your solution or to seek permission from those responsible? What does each approach cost?

What LoveCards Are, and Why Something So Small

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

For decades, our ministry has combated this decline through the simple, yet powerful act of giving out LoveCards. LoveCards are tools that convey God's message of love and redirect individuals and families back to His principles as found in the Bible.

At the centre of a proposal to a paramount ruler about the eradication of poverty sits a card. Not a bank, not a scheme, not a ministry building. A card that carries a message and is handed from one person to another. A reader is entitled to ask whether this is serious.

What the letter says a LoveCard does

- It **conveys God's message of love** — the content is not the giver's opinion but Scripture's teaching.
- It **redirects individuals and families** — the aim is a change of direction, not merely a warm feeling.
- It points **back to His principles as found in the Bible** — the card is a signpost to a greater book, never a replacement for it.
- It has been used **for decades**, which is a claim about persistence rather than novelty.

Why smallness is a strength, not a weakness

Four practical advantages follow from the humility of the instrument, and they are worth naming because they explain why a lifetime project could reasonably be built on it.

1. **It costs almost nothing, so anybody can do it.** A plan that requires wealth excludes the very people most affected by poverty. A card can be given by a widow, a student or a trader.
2. **It crosses barriers that a sermon cannot.** A card may be received by a man who would never enter a church building, and it can be read in private where pride does not have to be defended in public.
3. **It is personal.** Something handed from one hand to another carries the weight of the giver's attention. A broadcast reaches many and obliges nobody.
4. **It multiplies without machinery.** Every person who receives one can give one. No budget line is required for the second generation of giving.

The biblical pattern of small beginnings

For who hath despised the day of small things?

Zechariah 4:10 (KJV)

Zechariah spoke to people discouraged by the modest scale of a rebuilt temple compared with the glory of the first. The rebuke is gentle and pointed: God does not measure as men measure. The Lord Jesus taught the same thing repeatedly about his kingdom.

Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and sowed in his field: which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs.

Matthew 13:31-32 (KJV)

The parable is not sentimental about small things for their own sake. It makes a claim about what grows. A seed is small and living; a stone is small and dead. The letter is betting that a message of love placed in a household is of the first kind.

An honest limitation

It should be said plainly that a card by itself changes nothing. Paper does not transform a home. What the letter is really describing is the giving — a person who cares enough to stop, to hand something over and to mean it. The card is the occasion of a human encounter, and the encounter is the instrument. Any reader who takes up this practice mechanically, distributing paper without attention or prayer, will find that it produces very little.

The card is not the power. It is the excuse for one person to care about another in the open.

For reflection

1. What small, repeatable thing could you do for your neighbours that costs you almost nothing and could be done for years?
2. Has anyone ever given you something small that changed your direction? What was it?
3. Where in your thinking have you despised the day of small things?

The Heritage of the Land: Pa Elton and the Men He Raised

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

This project is in alignment with the spiritual heritage of Ijesha Land, as exemplified by the great missionary Pa Elton and perpetuated by the godly men he raised here.

The letter grounds its proposal in a specific local memory. It names a missionary called Pa Elton, describes him as great, and says his work was carried on by godly men he raised in Ijesha Land. These

notes will add nothing to that description. What the letter asserts about him is what this edition asserts; readers who wish to know more should seek out the local and church histories of the region rather than rely on a study booklet.

Why an argument reaches for heritage

The appeal is doing real work in the letter, and it is worth seeing how. A proposal that says *let us begin something new* asks a people to take a risk. A proposal that says *let us return to what your fathers already proved* asks them to be faithful. The second is almost always the stronger appeal, and in this case the writer believes it is also the truer one.

It also quietly answers an objection. A minister proposing a spiritual solution to material poverty may be told that such things do not work in the real world. Pointing to a heritage already present in the land is a way of replying: this has been done here before, and its fruit is not a theory.

Scripture and the memory of the fathers

Thus saith the LORD, Stand ye in the ways, and see, and ask for the old paths, where is the good way, and walk therein, and ye shall find rest for your souls.

Jeremiah 6:16 (KJV)

Jeremiah's instruction is not nostalgia. He does not say that everything old is good; he says to ask for the old paths **where is the good way**, which requires discernment about which of the old paths were good. The letter makes exactly this distinction, since it wishes to recover godly love while burning out greed that has also had time to take root.

We have heard with our ears, O God, our fathers have told us, what work thou didst in their days, in the times of old.

Psalms 44:1 (KJV)

The debt of one generation to the next

The phrase “perpetuated by the godly men he raised here” carries a whole philosophy of ministry in a few words. The missionary's significance, as the letter tells it, lies not only in what he did but in whom he raised. That is the apostolic pattern:

And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.

2 Timothy 2:2 (KJV)

Four generations are visible in that single verse: Paul, Timothy, faithful men, and others also. Work that stops with the worker dies with him. Work committed to others outlives everybody involved. A lifetime project, as this letter proposes, only makes sense if it is built on this principle from the first day.

For reflection

1. Who in your family or church raised you spiritually, and whom are you raising?
2. What good thing existed in your community a generation ago that has not been passed on? Why was it dropped?
3. Which of the old paths in your own culture are good, and which should not be recovered? How do you tell the difference?

Love as the Foundation of a Prosperous Community

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

The foundation of a prosperous community lies in families grounded in love: love that begins in the home and flows outward to transform society. Our lifetime project to eradicate poverty in homes and families using LoveCards is rooted in this timeless truth.

This sentence is the thesis of the whole letter. Everything before it is approach and everything after it is application. The claim is that prosperity is downstream of love, that love is learned in families, and that a society is therefore transformed from the inside of its homes outward rather than from the top of its institutions down.

The chain of the argument

1. Love is learned first in the home, from those who raise us.
2. People formed by love behave differently in public — they steal less, share more, keep their word, and consider their neighbour.
3. A community whose members behave in that way is a community where enterprise, trust and cooperation become possible.
4. Prosperity grows in such soil and fails in its opposite.
5. Therefore the most efficient point at which to attack poverty is not the market but the household.

Each step deserves examination, and a reader is free to test them. But the shape of the argument is clear, and it explains why a letter about poverty spends most of its length talking about hearts and homes rather than about trade or infrastructure.

Why trust is an economic asset

This is not only a spiritual claim; it has a very practical edge. Consider how much of the cost of doing business anywhere consists of protecting yourself from other people: the money spent on security, the contracts that must be enforced, the goods that must be guarded, the bribes that must be paid, the opportunities never taken because the partner cannot be trusted. Every one of those costs is a tax levied by the absence of love and honesty.

Where people can be trusted, that tax falls. Money that was spent defending is available for building. This is why the letter's claim is not sentimental: a community of trustworthy people is materially richer than an identical community of untrustworthy ones, with the same land, the same resources and the same skills.

Beginning in the home

And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart: and thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.

Deuteronomy 6:6-7 (KJV)

The instruction is domestic and constant: sitting, walking, lying down, rising up. It assumes that the decisive teaching of a nation happens in ordinary household hours rather than in ceremonies. Whatever a people truly believe is what their children hear said at home when nobody is performing.

Flowing outward

But let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream.

Amos 5:24 (KJV)

The prophet's image is of something that begins somewhere and travels. Water runs downhill and spreads. The letter's picture of love that "begins in the home and flows outward to transform society" is the same image applied to a nation's households. Nothing flows from a dry source; a society cannot receive from its homes what those homes do not contain.

What the home does not contain, the nation cannot inherit.

For reflection

1. Test the chain of argument above. Which step do you find strongest, and which weakest?
2. How much does distrust cost you, in money and in opportunities, in a normal month?
3. What is being taught in your household in the ordinary hours, whether or not anyone intends to teach it?

The Diagnosis: A Deficit of Love

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

At the heart of the societal challenges facing our country today (greed, division, and moral decay) lies a deficit of LOVE. This erosion of love within homes has led to both moral and financial bankruptcy, as materialism and the love of money take the helm.

Here the letter makes its diagnosis, and it is a bold one. Three great national problems are named — greed, division, moral decay — and all three are traced to a single root. Not to bad policy. Not to colonial history. Not to a shortage of resources. To a deficit of love.

Why a diagnosis matters more than a complaint

Anybody can list what is wrong with a country; it requires no skill and changes nothing. A diagnosis is different. It commits itself to a cause, and by doing so it makes itself testable and it points to a treatment. Whoever accepts this diagnosis knows immediately where to begin working. Whoever rejects it is obliged to offer a better account of the same symptoms.

The reader should notice, too, that a diagnosis of this kind implicates everybody. If the cause were merely bad government, the citizen could wait. If the cause is a deficit of love in homes, then no one in a home is a spectator.

The word “deficit”

The letter chooses a financial word deliberately. A deficit is not a total absence; it is a shortfall, a persistent gap between what is required and what is present. Most Nigerian homes are not without love. They are running at a shortfall — some love, but not enough to cover what is demanded of it, and so the account is steadily depleted.

That is a more accurate and more merciful description than saying that people do not love at all, and it also explains why the decay is gradual. Deficits do not announce themselves on any single day. They accumulate.

Three symptoms, one root

- **Greed** is love turned inward. It is not the desire to have but the refusal to consider anybody else while having.
- **Division** is love withdrawn from those unlike us. Where love is scarce it is rationed, and the first people cut off are those of another family, town, tribe or faith.
- **Moral decay** is love replaced by appetite. Where nothing is loved above the self, nothing restrains the self.

The love of money

For the love of money is the root of all evil: which while some coveted after, they have erred from the faith, and pierced themselves through with many sorrows.

1 Timothy 6:10 (KJV)

The verse is precise, and it is constantly misquoted. It does not say money is the root of evil. It says the **love** of money is. Money is a tool, and tools are morally neutral. What corrupts is the affection — the moment money stops being a means and becomes the thing the heart actually pursues.

Paul's described consequence is worth weighing: those who covet after it have "pierced themselves through with many sorrows". The wound is self-inflicted. That is exactly the letter's argument about poverty — that a great deal of the misery is caused, not merely suffered, by the people it falls upon.

Moral bankruptcy before financial bankruptcy

The letter's order is significant: "both moral and financial bankruptcy", moral named first. It is claiming a sequence, not a coincidence. A society first loses its honesty, its restraint and its care for the next man; the empty treasury follows later, as the accumulated result of ten thousand private decisions to take rather than to build.

Righteousness exalteth a nation: but sin is a reproach to any people.

Proverbs 14:34 (KJV)

For reflection

1. Do you accept the letter's diagnosis? If not, what better explanation do you offer for the same three symptoms?
2. Where, honestly, is your own household running a deficit of love rather than an absence of it?
3. Can you name a sorrow in your own life or family that was self-inflicted by the pursuit of money?

Burning Out the Weeds of Greed and Materialism

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

Our mission is to reignite the flame of LOVE in the hearts of Ijesha people; to burn out the weeds of greed and materialism that have taken root.

The letter's picture of greed is agricultural. Greed and materialism are weeds; they have taken root; they must be burned out. Every part of that image is chosen, and a farming people will recognise all of it.

Weeds are never planted

Nobody sows weeds. They arrive on their own, they require no attention, and they thrive precisely where good seed is not being cultivated. That is the first thing the image teaches about greed: it is the default condition of a heart left untended. A household does not have to teach its children to want more than their share. It has to teach them not to.

Weeds compete for what the crop needs

A weed does not merely occupy space. It drinks the same water, feeds on the same soil and blocks the same light that the crop requires. So it is with materialism in a family: the hours, the ambition, the conversation and the affection that would have gone to raising children, serving a church or helping a neighbour are consumed by the pursuit of things. Nothing is announced as abandoned. It is simply crowded out.

He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.

Matthew 13:22 (KJV)

The Lord's own use of the same image is exact. The seed in the thorny ground is not unplanted, and the hearer is not an unbeliever; the word was received. What went wrong was competition. Care and riches choked it, and the result was not wickedness but unfruitfulness — a life that came to nothing in particular.

Roots must be dealt with, not leaves

A farmer who cuts the tops off weeds is doing work that will need to be repeated next week. The letter says these weeds have “taken root”, and it proposes to burn them out rather than trim them. Applied to a life, that means the pursuit is not corrected by reducing expenditure or by giving a little more to charity. It is corrected by a change in what the heart actually wants.

Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal: but lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven ... For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

Matthew 6:19-21 (KJV)

The last clause explains the whole method. The heart follows the treasure, not the other way round. This is why exhortation alone rarely changes a materialist: he is not misbehaving against his own desires, he is obeying them. Change what is treasured and the behaviour follows on its own.

What materialism actually promises, and why it lies

- It promises **security**, and delivers anxiety, because there is no amount at which a fearful man feels safe.
- It promises **status**, and delivers comparison, because there is always someone ahead.

- It promises **freedom**, and delivers bondage, because possessions must be maintained, guarded and replaced.
- It promises **respect from others**, and often purchases only their envy.

He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance with increase: this is also vanity.

Ecclesiastes 5:10 (KJV)

Solomon had the means to test this claim more thoroughly than anyone else in Scripture, and his verdict is not that wealth is evil but that it does not satisfy. That is a different and more damaging charge, because it means the pursuit fails on its own terms.

Weeds need no planting. Good crops need tending. That is the whole work.

What is planted in the place of the weeds

Burning alone leaves bare ground, and bare ground grows weeds again. The letter is careful to pair its burning with a planting: **reignite the flame of LOVE, restore the foundation of godly love**. Any household that only forbids greed without cultivating love will find the forbidding does not last.

For reflection

1. What has quietly crowded out of your life in the last five years — a relationship, a service, a habit of prayer — without any decision being made?
2. Which of materialism's four promises has had the strongest hold on you?
3. If your heart follows your treasure, what does your spending over the last month say you treasure?

The Witness: Families Restored, Youth Redirected

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

We have witnessed profound transformations in homes and communities where these LoveCards were received: families restored, youth redirected, and entrepreneurial spirits awakened, resulting in tangible economic upliftment.

A proposal must eventually answer the question *has this ever worked?* Here the letter offers its evidence. It is testimony rather than statistics: the writer says what has been witnessed. These notes will neither inflate that claim with invented examples nor dismiss it, and the reader should weigh it as the personal testimony it is.

Four claims in order

1. **Families restored.** Broken relationships repaired — the primary and most costly failure of a society addressed at its own level.
2. **Youth redirected.** Young people turned from one course of life to another before the damage was permanent.
3. **Entrepreneurial spirits awakened.** Initiative appearing where passivity had been.
4. **Tangible economic upliftment.** Material improvement following the other three.

The order is the argument. Economic improvement is placed last, as consequence rather than cause. The letter is claiming that when the first three occur, the fourth tends to follow — which is precisely the thesis stated earlier about love being the foundation of a prosperous community.

Why restored families produce material improvement

The connection is not mystical, and it is worth setting out plainly.

- A restored marriage stops the enormous expense of separation: two households, divided property, disrupted schooling, and the earnings lost to conflict and litigation.
- A household at peace can plan. People who are fighting cannot save, because saving requires trusting the other person with a shared future.
- Children in a stable home attend school more consistently and are more likely to finish.
- Extended family obligations are met more willingly where relationships are healthy, which is itself a form of social insurance in a society without much other provision.
- A man who is not drinking away his income, and a woman who is not hiding hers, are together far wealthier than the same two people in a house without trust.

Why awakened initiative matters more than aid

The phrase “entrepreneurial spirits awakened” is important because it describes a change in the person rather than a transfer to them. Aid relieves a condition; awakened initiative changes a capacity. One ends when the giver stops; the other continues and multiplies.

Underneath it lies a theological point the letter assumes without arguing. A person who believes they are loved by God and made in his image has grounds for believing they can build something. Hopelessness is not only a mood; it is a settled belief about what one is worth and what one is able to do, and it is the most expensive poverty of all.

The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason.

Proverbs 26:16 (KJV)

Scripture is unsentimental about idleness and it is equally unsentimental about labour’s reward: “In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury” (Proverbs 14:23). Both verses

assume a person who believes their effort will come to something. That belief is the thing the letter says LoveCards awaken.

Testimony and its limits

Honesty requires a word here. Testimony of the kind offered in this letter is real evidence, and it is the kind of evidence ordinary people trust most, because they can see the person and know the family. It is also limited: it cannot tell us how many received a card and changed nothing, and it cannot separate what the card did from what else was happening in those homes. A wise reader receives the testimony gratefully and still asks for it to be tested over the long life of the project the letter proposes.

For reflection

1. Have you seen a family restored? What did it change about their circumstances, not only their feelings?
2. Name a young person whose direction changed in time. Who was involved?
3. Where in your own life has hopelessness cost you more than lack of money has?

Aligning with the Vision of a New Reign

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

As His Royal Majesty assumes the revered throne, his commitment to fostering unity, peace, and progress in Ijesha Land is clear. This lifetime project to eradicate poverty in homes and families using LoveCards aligns seamlessly with that vision.

This paragraph performs a specific task in the letter, and it is worth studying by anyone who has ever had to put a proposal before someone in authority. The writer does not argue that the king should adopt his priorities. He argues that his project already serves the king's own stated priorities.

The difference between asking and aligning

A petitioner who says *here is what I want* asks the person in authority to make room for someone else's agenda. A petitioner who says *here is how what you already want can be achieved* offers a service. The second is not flattery, provided it is true; it is the ordinary courtesy of taking another person's responsibilities seriously before asking anything of them.

The discipline this requires is real. It means finding out what the other party is actually committed to, believing that they mean it, and then honestly examining whether your proposal serves it. A proposal that cannot pass that test probably should not be brought.

Unity, peace and progress

The three words the letter attributes to the king's vision are the same three it used in its own opening greeting — love, unity and progress — with peace in the place of love. The letter is quietly demonstrating that the alignment it claims is not invented at this late point but was present from the first line.

Honour, blessing and multiplied effect

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

By launching this initiative under your reign, we will not only honour the values and traditions of Ijesha Land but also create a spiritual and economic blueprint for the future.

Two returns are offered to the throne: honour now, and a blueprint for the future. The second is the larger claim. A blueprint is something others can copy, which means the proposal is not asking the king merely to permit a work in his own domain but to allow Ijesha Land to become the pattern from which other places learn.

Working with authority rather than around it

Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.

Proverbs 11:14 (KJV)

A work that proceeds without the knowledge of those responsible for a community may accomplish something for a while, but it will lack both counsel and covering. The letter chooses the harder and slower road of seeking the throne's blessing first. That road costs time and risks refusal; what it buys is legitimacy, and legitimacy is what allows a work to last beyond its founder.

A caution for the reader

Alignment has a shadow side, and Scripture knows it well. There were prophets in Israel who aligned themselves so thoroughly with power that they lost the ability to say anything power did not wish to hear. The letter avoids this, because its central message — that greed must be burned out and love restored — is not comfortable for anyone, ruler or subject. Anyone who takes up this method should test their own proposals the same way: if your message has become something no one could possibly object to, you may have aligned yourself out of a message.

Serve the vision of those in authority. Do not surrender your own.

For reflection

1. Think of a request you need to make of someone in authority. What are they actually committed to, and how does your request serve it?

2. Have you ever sought permission where you could have proceeded quietly? What did seeking it cost, and what did it gain?
3. Where might a desire to be welcomed have softened something you needed to say?

A Unifying Force and the Redirection of Youth

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

This project will serve as a unifying force that will encourage collaboration, respect, and shared progress. It will also spark the creativity of the youth, steering them away from vices and redirecting them into channels of productivity that will boost Ijesha's economy and reputation globally.

Two further effects are promised: unity among the people, and a redirection of the young. Both are worth taking apart, because both are places where a project of this kind either proves itself or fails visibly.

Why a message of love unifies

Division is usually maintained by two beliefs: that the other group is not quite as human as ours, and that what they gain we lose. A message that insists every person is loved by God and is to be loved by us attacks the first belief directly. A project that operates household by household, across every quarter of a town without regard to which family or party a house belongs to, attacks the second by demonstration.

And that he might reconcile both unto God in one body by the cross, having slain the enmity thereby.

Ephesians 2:16 (KJV)

Paul is describing the deepest division known to his world — between Jew and Gentile — and he says the cross did not merely manage it but slew the enmity itself. That is the pattern the letter invokes when it calls the project a unifying force. Not a negotiated truce between groups, but a removal of the ground on which the hostility stood.

The specific crisis of the young

The letter speaks of “steering them away from vices and redirecting them into channels of productivity”, and the word *redirecting* concedes something important: the energy is already there. Young people are not idle by nature. Where honest channels are closed or appear closed, the same drive, cleverness and appetite for risk that would have built a business goes into fraud, cultism, drugs or violence.

This reframes the problem. The task is not to suppress youthful energy but to open channels for it and to give reasons for choosing the harder, slower, honest one. Both halves are necessary. Moral exhortation without opportunity produces cynicism; opportunity without moral formation simply produces better-resourced dishonesty.

What actually redirects a young person

- **Someone who believes in them.** Almost every redirected life has a person behind it.
- **A reason larger than money.** Fraud pays well in the short term; only a different definition of a successful life competes with it.
- **A visible honest path.** Young people imitate what they can see succeeding around them.
- **Work to do now.** Idleness is the soil in which every vice roots.
- **A community that will notice.** Anonymity is the friend of vice; being known is a protection.

Train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.

Proverbs 22:6 (KJV)

Note that the proverb speaks of training rather than telling, and of a way to go rather than merely a way to avoid. Training is patient, repeated and practical, and it points somewhere. That is exactly the difference between warning the young against vice and redirecting them into productivity.

Reputation as a national asset

The letter's mention of "reputation globally" is not vanity. A people's reputation is an economic fact: it determines whether others will trade with them, invest among them, employ them and visit them. Where a reputation for dishonesty exists, every honest person of that nation pays a tax they did not incur. Restoring the reputation of a people is therefore an act of justice towards the honest majority.

A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.

Proverbs 22:1 (KJV)

For reflection

1. Which divisions in your own community would be hardest for a project like this to cross, and why?
2. Name one young person whose energy is currently going nowhere. What channel could you open for them?
3. What has your community's reputation cost its honest members?

Education, Mindset and the Resources of the Land

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

Families and youth across communities will be empowered through love-centered education and training that will shift mindsets, eliminate ignorance, and foster wealth generation using the abundant natural and human resources of Ijesha.

This sentence names the method by which the letter expects change to actually happen: education and training. It also states plainly what is to be changed — mindsets — and what is to be used — resources already present in the land.

“Love-centered education”

The phrase distinguishes this from schooling as such. Education that transfers skill without forming character produces capable people whose capability may be turned to anything at all. The letter’s premise throughout is that a nation’s problem is not a shortage of clever people but a shortage of clever people who love their neighbour.

The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.

Proverbs 1:7 (KJV)

Scripture does not treat reverence as an alternative to knowledge; it treats it as the starting point of knowledge. That is a claim about order rather than about content. Learn everything, the proverb implies, but learn it as a creature before God, or the learning will not make you wise.

Shifting mindsets

Of everything the letter proposes, this is the hardest and the most necessary. A mindset is not an opinion that can be corrected with information. It is the set of assumptions a person does not know they hold — about what is possible for someone like them, about whether effort is rewarded, about whether wealth must be seized because it cannot be built, about whether one’s gain requires another’s loss.

Several such assumptions are directly addressed by the message the letter carries:

- *Nothing I do will change anything.* Answered by the claim that a household can change and that change spreads.
- *Only the dishonest get ahead.* Answered by the insistence that honesty is the foundation of durable prosperity, and by visible examples of it.
- *What he gains, I lose.* Answered by love, which makes a neighbour’s gain tolerable and then desirable.

- *Poverty is simply my portion.* Answered by the doctrine that a person is made in the image of God and entrusted with work to do.

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind.

Romans 12:2 (KJV)

Paul's word for the change is *renewing of the mind*, and the verb is passive — be transformed. The renewal is something done to a person as they are exposed, repeatedly, to a different account of reality. That is why the letter proposes decades of patient distribution rather than a single campaign.

Wealth from resources already present

The letter's final phrase deserves emphasis: wealth generation “using the abundant natural and human resources of Ijesha”. Nothing is to be imported. The proposal does not depend on a donor, a foreign partner or a government allocation. It assumes the land and its people already possess what is needed and that what has been missing is the love, vision and trust required to put those resources to work together.

This is a dignifying assumption, and it is also the only kind of plan that can last. Help that arrives from outside ends when the outside loses interest. Capacity that is awakened inside does not.

The resources are already here. What has been missing is the love to use them together.

For reflection

1. Which of the four mindsets listed above do you recognise in yourself or in those around you?
2. What resources — natural, human, or simply unused hours — already exist in your community and go to waste?
3. What would love-centred education look like in the school or trade your own children are being prepared for?

One Family at a Time: The Closing Request

One page of the original letter is not available. The surviving text resumes in the middle of a sentence.

FROM THE ORIGINAL LEAFLET

... lifetime project focused on eradicating poverty in homes and families using LoveCards, together we can build a legacy that reflects the heart of God and the strength of our people.

We humbly seek the opportunity to contribute to this reign by laying the foundation for revival and progress, one family at a time.

We await your kind consideration and remain available for further discussions at your convenience. May your reign be remembered as the golden age of love, light, and lasting prosperity in Ijesha Land.

The letter ends as it began: humbly, with honour, and with a request rather than a demand. Three things in this closing deserve to be carried away by the reader.

“One family at a time”

This phrase is the whole strategy compressed into four words, and it is the answer to the objection that a card cannot fix a nation. Nobody proposes to fix a nation. The proposal is to reach a family, and then another, for a lifetime, and to trust that a nation is nothing other than the sum of its families.

There is great relief in this for an ordinary reader. You are not required to solve poverty. You are required to love the household in front of you. That is a task of a size that a human being can actually attempt.

Who hath despised the day of small things? for they shall rejoice, and shall see the plummet in the hand of Zerubbabel.

Zechariah 4:10 (KJV)

“A legacy that reflects the heart of God and the strength of our people”

Both halves of that phrase are necessary. A work that reflects only the heart of God, without engaging the strength of a people, becomes something done to them. A work that relies only on the strength of a people, without the heart of God, becomes another scheme among many. The letter asks for both, and it places God’s heart first.

“We await your kind consideration”

The last posture of the letter is waiting. Having made its case as strongly as it can, it submits the outcome to someone else’s decision. This is not weakness; it is the necessary conclusion of having sought permission honestly. A petitioner who cannot bear to wait was never really asking.

Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established.

Proverbs 16:3 (KJV)

A note on what we do not know

As these notes said at the beginning, the letter cannot tell us what came of it, and this edition will not invent an ending. What can be said is that the case does not depend on the reply. Every argument in the letter — that love is the foundation of prosperity, that homes are where a nation is made, that greed is a weed requiring burning, that small persistent acts change communities — can be acted upon today by any

reader, with or without a royal blessing.

You do not need a king's permission to love the family next door.

For reflection

1. Which single family, other than your own, could you deliberately love over the next year?
2. What legacy are you actually building, whether or not you intended to build one?
3. Is there something you have been waiting for permission to do that requires no permission at all?

Taking This Letter to Your Own Town

This booklet has treated a letter written to one king about one land. But the argument inside it is not local, and a reader in Kano, Aba, Lagos, London or anywhere else can act on it this week. This section turns the letter into steps.

For a household

1. **Name the deficit.** Sit down with your spouse, or alone before God, and ask honestly where love is running short in your own house — in speech, in time, in money, in attention.
2. **Make one repair.** Choose the relationship in your household most in need of mending and take the first step this week, without waiting for the other party to move first.
3. **Teach at the ordinary hours.** Deuteronomy 6 puts the teaching at sitting, walking, lying down and rising up. Choose one of those four and use it deliberately.
4. **Deal with a weed.** Identify one materialist habit in your home — a pursuit, a purchase, a comparison — and pull it out by the root rather than trimming it.

For a fellowship or church

1. **Teach that prosperity has moral foundations,** so that members stop expecting a harvest from unsown ground.
2. **Give something small to give.** A card, a tract, a printed verse — put an instrument in ordinary members' hands so that witness does not depend on the gifted few.
3. **Adopt families rather than running events.** Assign real households to real members who will know them over years.
4. **Open a channel for the young.** Skills, apprenticeship, mentorship, honest employment — anything that makes an honest path visible.
5. **Measure over years, not weeks.** Agree at the start what you will look at in five years' time.

For anyone with influence

1. **Bring the case to those responsible**, as this letter did, rather than complaining about them.
2. **Frame it as service to what they already want**, honestly.
3. **Ask for blessing, not only for funds**. Permission and covering often matter more than money.
4. **Be willing to wait**, and to be refused, without abandoning the work.

What to expect

A reader should be prepared for the pace of this. Nothing described in the letter produces quick or measurable results. Homes change slowly, mindsets change more slowly still, and the fruit of a family changed today may not be visible until its children are grown. That is precisely why the proposal is for a lifetime and not a season.

Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and latter rain.

James 5:7 (KJV)

For reflection

1. Which single step above will you take first, and on what day?
2. Who will you tell, so that someone asks you about it later?
3. What will you look at in five years to know whether anything changed?

A Prayer and a Commitment

The letter closed by committing its request to a king and its outcome to God. This study edition closes the same way, with the reader's own household in view.

A prayer

Our Father, God of love and giver of every good gift, we thank you for the land you have placed us in, for its people, its resources and its history. We confess that we have often sought increase without seeking you, and that greed has grown among us as a weed grows in an untended field. Forgive us, Lord.

Reignite love in our homes. Burn out the roots of greed, envy and the love of money in our own hearts before we ask it of anyone else. Restore husbands to wives, parents to children, and neighbours to one another. Awaken those who have given up, and open honest channels for our young people, that their strength may build and not destroy.

Bless those in authority over us: give them wisdom, integrity and courage, and let their years be remembered for justice and peace. Raise up in every community those who will love one family at a time and not grow weary. Make our households a place from which love flows outward, until it reaches our streets, our markets and our nation. In the name of Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

A commitment

Write the names and the dates. A commitment without either is only a wish.

1. The relationship in my household I will begin to repair is _____, and I will take the first step on _____.
2. The materialist habit I will pull out by the root is _____.
3. The family outside my own that I will deliberately love this year is _____.
4. The young person whose direction I will invest in is _____.
5. The person in authority I will pray for by name each week is _____.
6. I will review all of the above on _____.

A final word

This was a letter from one man to one king, written the day after a coronation, asking for the honour of beginning a work that would take the rest of his life. Its argument is that poverty is not finally a problem of money but of love; that love is made or lost in families; and that a land is restored one household at a time by people patient enough to keep at it for decades.

Whatever answer the throne gave, the argument now stands in front of you, and it asks for an answer of a different kind.

But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.

James 1:22 (KJV)

Revival and progress, one family at a time. Begin with yours.